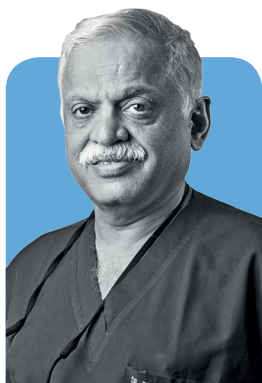


“We have witnessed significant growth in demand for pain care products owing to rising cases of body pain due to the pandemic-induced sedentary lifestyle”

SHIVAM PURI
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER,
CIPLA HEALTH LTD



“The number of patients requiring such (arthroscopic repair) surgeries is increasing as patient awareness about shoulder pain improves after the pandemic”

DR DEEPAK CHAUDHARY
HEAD, DEPARTMENT OF ARTHROSCOPY
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SUPER SPECIALITY HOSPITAL

“The growth of the sports medicine market is driven by several factors, including the increasing prevalence of sports-related injuries, a growing emphasis on physical fitness and sports participation, advancements in sports medicine technology, and a rising awareness of the importance of injury prevention and management in sports,” says Natarajan. He adds that the sports medicine market goes beyond medicines and includes orthopaedic devices, surgical equipment, and performance monitoring devices.

Dr Debashish Chanda, Lead Consultant-Orthopaedics at CK Birla Hospital in Gurugram, says innovative pain management and muscle relaxation combinations are also spurring the market growth.

“Certain companies have even introduced similar products under multiple brand names, recognising the immense potential of this market. This upward trend in demand for such medications can be

attributed to various factors, with one notable influence being the post-Covid-19 era,” says Chanda.

The orthopaedic surgeon says that many people, locked indoors by the Covid-19 shutdown, took advice from physical fitness experts and self-proclaimed experts on YouTube and Facebook. Injuries became common because people tried out exercises without the physical presence of coaches. “Consequently, both topical application creams and oral medications experienced a significant rise in sales,” says Chanda.

The pharmaceuticals industry has responded quickly, introducing many new molecules and drug combinations for topical and oral medications and expanding patient treatment choices.

Chanda believes that the market growth is much greater than what is visible. “Many patients purchase over-the-counter medicines without consulting doctors, as the market demand has become so vast that it overwhelms the healthcare system. As a result, the actual number of patients seeking medical attention may be underestimated,” he says.

And it is not just the exercise craze leading to more pain.

Those not caught by the exercise bug are probably glued for hours to their smartphones or laptops, playing computer games or just hooked to social media. Sitting or lying for long periods is bad for your back or hips.

“The growth in the pain management and muscle relaxant market is undeniable and continues to show immense potential. We may only be seeing the tip of the iceberg, as this upward trajectory is projected to continue in the foreseeable future, redefining the landscape of healthcare and patient well-being,” says Chanda. **BT**

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